



Date: xxxxx

Team ID: xxxxx

Project Name: Virtual Agent-Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System

Virtual Agent-Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System

Objective: To enhance SLA governance through proactive awareness, structured accountability, and real-time reporting using ServiceNow Admin capabilities without the use of scripting.

Project Description

The Virtual Agent-Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System is designed to provide centralized visibility and governance over Service Level Agreements (SLAs). By leveraging ServiceNow's Flow Designer and Virtual Agent, the system automatically triggers notifications when an SLA reaches a critical threshold (80%). It mandates that assignees provide specific breach reasons and justifications directly within the Incident form or through a conversational Virtual Agent interface, ensuring that every breach is documented and acknowledged.

Scenarios

- **Scenario 1: Proactive SLA Warning:** An incident SLA reaches 80% of its duration. The system automatically triggers a "SLA At Risk" flag on the incident and sends a warning email to the assignee with a link to the Virtual Agent for immediate acknowledgement.
- **Scenario 2: Conversational Justification:** An agent interacts with the Virtual Agent on the Service Portal. The bot identifies the at-risk SLA, guides the agent through providing a breach reason (e.g., "Dependency on third party"), and records the acknowledgement.

- **Scenario 3: Management Oversight:** A Service Desk Manager accesses the SLA Governance Dashboard to view a pie chart of "SLA Breaches by Reason" and a list of "Pending Justifications" to identify systemic bottlenecks and ensure team accountability.

Technical Architecture

The system utilizes a modular ServiceNow-native architecture:

- **Data Layer:** Enhanced Incident table with custom fields: SLA Breach Reason (Choice), SLA Breach Justification (String), and SLA Acknowledged (True/False).
- **Logic Layer:** Flow Designer handles "SLA at Risk" notifications and field updates when the business elapsed percentage exceeds 80%.
- **Interaction Layer:** Virtual Agent (ITSM Conversations) provides the conversational interface for risk acknowledgement.
- **Governance Layer:** UI Policies enforce field visibility and mandatory requirements based on the SLA state.
- **Analytics Layer:** Dashboards and Reports visualize performance trends and breach distributions.

Project Workflow

Milestone 1: Requirement Analysis & Planning

- **Activity 1.1:** Define SLA definitions (e.g., Incident Resolution - 8 hours) and business schedules.
- **Activity 1.2:** Map the data architecture, including necessary custom fields on the Incident table.

Milestone 2: Backend Configuration & Data Setup

- **Activity 2.1:** Create custom fields on the Incident table: `u_sla_breach_reason`, `u_sla_breach_justification`, and `u_sla_acknowledgement`.
- **Activity 2.2:** Configure SLA Breach Reason choices: Dependency on third party, Awaiting user response, Incorrect categorization, System outage, and Approval delay.

Milestone 3: Notification Logic & UI Policy

- **Activity 3.1:** Develop a Flow in Flow Designer triggered when a Task SLA reaches $\geq 80\%$ business elapsed percentage.
- **Activity 3.2:** Configure UI Policies to make SLA Breach fields mandatory and visible only when "SLA at Risk" is true.

Milestone 4: Virtual Agent Design & Configuration

- **Activity 4.1:** Install the ITSM Virtual Agent Conversations plugin.
- **Activity 4.2:** Create the "SLA Breach Awareness & Justification" topic to guide users through the acknowledgement process.

Milestone 5: Reporting & Dashboard Setup

- **Activity 5.1:** Create reports for "SLA Breaches by Reason," "Top Assignees with SLA Violations," and "Pending Justifications".
- **Activity 5.2:** Consolidate reports into a centralized SLA Governance & Accountability Dashboard.

Milestone 6: Testing & Validation

- **Activity 6.1:** Execute test cases for incident creation, SLA attachment, 80% trigger, and Virtual Agent invocation.
- **Activity 6.2:** Verify that management emails contain the correct dashboard links and incident details.

Conclusion

The Virtual Agent-Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System provides a robust, no-code solution for SLA management. By integrating real-time notifications with conversational AI, the system ensures that performance gaps are not only identified but also justified and acknowledged by the workforce. This structured approach improves audit readiness and provides leadership with actionable data to refine service delivery processes. Future

enhancements could include automated escalation flows if justifications remain empty beyond the breach point.